

Logo Concept & Refinement

After reviewing the provided concepts, the most suitable starting point is the cartoon owl with a graduation cap on top of books.

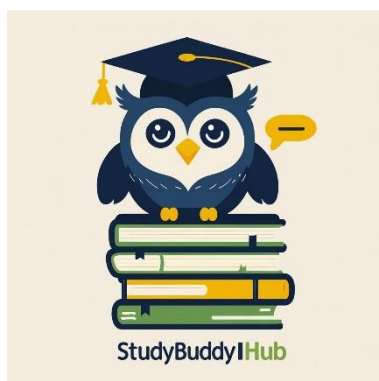
Rationale for Choice:

The owl is a classic symbol of wisdom and knowledge, making it instantly recognizable in an educational context. The graduation cap reinforces the tertiary education focus. This approachable, slightly playful character aligns perfectly with the brand's Supportive and Relatable personality, making it appealing to the primary audience (like Sipho and Mary-Ann) without feeling overly corporate or intimidating.

Refinements for Aesthetics, Clarity, and Scalability:

- **Aesthetics:** Simplify the illustration. Reduce intricate details in the feathers and books to create a cleaner, more modern look. Ensure the owl's expression is friendly and encouraging.
- **Clarity:** Bolden the key lines to ensure the logo remains clear when scaled down. The graduation cap and book stack should be unmistakable elements.
- **Scalability:** Test the logo at various sizes (e.g., 24px favicon, 500px header) to guarantee the owl's face and core elements are still discernible. Adjust line weights and spacing accordingly.

The refined logo mark is shown below:



Logo Lockup:

The primary logo will be a **horizontal lockup** combining the refined icon with the logotype.



Initial Logo Usage Guidelines

1. Variations

To ensure flexibility across different applications, the following logo variations are approved:

- **Primary Logo (Horizontal):** The full-colour horizontal lockup is the primary logo for most applications (website headers, merchandise, presentations).
- **Stacked Logo (Vertical):** A vertically arranged version for spaces where horizontal space is limited (e.g., social media profile pictures, mobile app icons).
- **Icon Only:** The owl icon alone may be used in extremely constrained spaces where the full logotype would be illegible (e.g., favicon, app launcher icon, small social media avatars).
- **Wordmark Only:** The "StudyBuddy Hub" logotype without the icon may be used in contexts where the icon has already been established nearby or in text-heavy environments.

2. Safe Zones (Exclusion Zone)

To protect the logo's integrity and ensure it always has prominence, a minimum area of clear space must surround it. This clear space is defined by the height of the letter "S" in the wordmark.

Minimum Clear Space = x

(x = the height of the 'S' in StudyBuddy)

No other graphic elements, text, or imagery should encroach upon this area.

3. Minimum Sizes

To maintain legibility and impact, the logo should not be reproduced smaller than the following sizes:

- **Print Applications:** 25mm width for the primary horizontal logo.
- **Digital Applications:** 100px width for the primary horizontal logo.
- **Icon Only:** 24px x 24px (for use as a favicon or similar).

4. Basic Colour Palette Considerations

The logo should be used in the following approved colour combinations to ensure consistency with the overall brand identity.

- **Primary (Full Colour):**
 - **Icon:** Owl in Navy Blue (#2C3E50), Cap Tassel and Book Covers in Sunshine Yellow (#FFD700), Book Pages in Grass Green (#4CAF50).
 - **Wordmark:** Navy Blue (#2C3E50).
 - **Background:** White or light neutral colours.
- **Reversed (Light Version):**
 - **Logo/Icon:** Entirely White or very light grey.
 - **Background:** Navy Blue (#2C3E50) or other dark brand colours. Ensure sufficient contrast.
- **Monochromatic:**
 - **Black:** For single colour print applications like photocopies or embossing.
 - **White:** For single-colour applications on dark backgrounds.

Unacceptable Use:

- Do not change the approved colour schemes.
- Do not place the full-colour logo on a clashing or overly busy background that reduces readability.
- Do not distort, rotate, or add effects like drop shadows or bevels to the logo.
- Do not recreate or alter the icon yourself; always use the provided master file.

